

Faith Ozemebhoya Aiya

McCarty Hall A, 1172, Gainesville, FL 32611-0241 | (352)-363-4228 |
faith.aiya@ufl.edu | www.linkedin.com/in/faith-aiya

Research Interest

- Experimental and Behavioral Economics
- Agricultural Marketing
- Neuro-economics

Education

Doctor of Philosophy | August 2023 - Present | University of Florida, Gainesville

- Major: Food and resource economics – (CGPA – 3.89 / 4.0)

Master of Science | Jan 2021 – May 2023 | University of Florida, Gainesville

- Major: Food and resource economics – (CGPA – 4.0 / 4.0)

Bachelor of Agriculture | Nov 2012-Nov 2017 | University of Benin, Nigeria

- Major: Agricultural Economics and Extension Services – (CGPA – 4.4 / 5.0)

Research Experience

Graduate Research Assistant | Jan 2021- Present | University of Florida, Gainesville

Conceptualizing and Validating State Image: Evidence from State-Sponsored Agricultural Marketing Programs in Out-of-State Markets

Supervisor: Dr. Lijun Chen and Dr. Kimberly Morgan.

- Analyzed data using responses from a multi-country survey of 998 respondents in the Northeastern United States and Canada.
- Utilized partial least squares structural equation modelling to examine and validate the state-image construct on out-of-state consumers' purchase intention of tomatoes branded with the *Fresh from Florida* state-sponsored marketing brand.
- Organized and moderated seven virtual focus groups with 41 participants across Florida, New York, and Canada examining consumer preferences for food products and labels.
- Presented findings at the 2025 Florida Agricultural Policy Outlook conference in Citra, Florida and at the 2025 Agricultural and Applied Economics Association meeting in Denver, CO.

Shifting Food Lifestyle Patterns Amid Macroeconomic Shocks (2019-2023)

Supervisor: Dr. Lijun Chen and Dr. Kimberly Morgan.

- Analyzed cross sectional data using responses from a nationwide survey of 16,800 respondents.
- Utilized Latent Class Analysis to analyze five dimensions of food lifestyles.
- Presented findings at the 2023 Agricultural and Applied Economics Association meeting in Washington, D.C.

Analysis of the Florida Citrus Fruit Crop Actual Production History Crop Insurance Policy

Supervisor: Dr. Ariel Singerman.

- Analyzed the risk management agency's premium rating methodology for a newly offered actual production history for Florida citrus growers and established the actuarial fairness of the policy.

- Utilized county-level data on yields and prices for Florida oranges to simulate the premium rates and indemnities for the Florida Citrus Fruit crop's actual production history crop insurance policy under different scenarios using Monte-Carlo Simulations.
- Presented findings at the 2022 Agricultural and Applied Economics Association meeting in Anaheim, California, and the 2022 Annual Food Distribution Research Society (FDRS) meeting in Pensacola, Florida.

Undergraduate Research Assistant | Oct 2016- Oct 2017 | University of Benin, Nigeria

The Profitability of Fresh Palm Fruit Processing into Palm Oil in Igueben Local Government Area, Edo State, Nigeria.

Supervisor: Dr. Osayi Emokpae.

- Analyzed the socio-economic characteristics of oil palm processors to determine the profitability of small-scale palm oil processing in Igueben.
- Designed a semi-structured questionnaire and collected data using face-to-face interviews with 70 oil palm processors.
- Utilized descriptive statistics, farm budget analysis, linear regression, and a 5-point Likert scale for research.

Journal Papers

1. Dai, S., Yu, H., **Aiya, F.**, Yang, B. (2024). "Green Bonds and Sustainable Development: Theoretical Model and Empirical Evidence from Europe". *International Journal of Sustainable Development & World Ecology*, DOI: 10.1080/13504509.2024.2325366

Working Papers

Shifting Food Lifestyle Patterns Amid Macroeconomic Shocks (2019-2023)

Faith Aiya, Lijun Chen, Kimberley Morgan, and Lisa House.

Under Review: *British Food Journal*

Conceptualizing and Validating State Image: Evidence from State-Sponsored Agricultural Marketing Programs in Out-of-State Markets

Faith Aiya, Lijun Chen, Bachir Kassas, Alex Magnaire, and Kimberley Morgan.

Under Review: *Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics*

An Exploration of Justice, Trust, Fairness, and Local Identity in Agricultural Marketing: Consumer Perceptions of the "Fresh from Florida" Program

Faith Aiya, Lijun Chen, Bachir Kassas, Alex Magnaire, Kimberley Morgan and Prabin Adhikari.

Manuscript in Progress

U.S Food Shopper Trends in 2017

Faith Aiya, Lijun Chen, and Brandon Marcsisin

Manuscript in Progress

Extension Works

Summary of 2021/22 Central Florida (Ridge) And Indian River-Southwest Florida Citrus Custom Rate Charges

Ariel Singerman and **Faith Aiya**.

<https://crec.ifas.ufl.edu/media/crecifasufledu/economics/202122-2020-Custom-Rate-Charges.pdf>

Summary of 2020/21 Central Florida (Ridge) And Indian River-Southwest Florida Citrus Custom Rate Charges

Ariel Singerman and Faith Aiya.

<https://crec.ifas.ufl.edu/media/crecifasufledu/new-site/documents/research/2020-Custom-Rate-Charges.pdf>

Conference Presentations

Shifting Food Lifestyle Patterns Among Food Consumers 2020-2022

- Selected Paper Presentation for the 2026 International Food and Agribusiness Management Association (IFAMA) World Conference in Ireland.

An Exploration of Justice, Trust, Fairness, and Local Identity in Agricultural Marketing: Consumer Perceptions of the “Fresh from Florida” Program

- Selected Paper Presentation for the 2025 Annual Meeting of Food Distribution Research Society Annual Meeting, San Diego.

Perceptions of the “Fresh from Florida” Program: Findings from Conversations with Florida, New York, and Canadian Fresh Produce Consumers

- Selected Paper Presentation for the 2025 Annual Meeting of the Florida Tomato Conference in Clewiston, FL.

Developing and Validating the State-Image Construct to Explain Out-of-State Consumer’s Behavioral Intention

- Selected Poster Presentation for the 2025 Annual Meeting of the Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) in Denver, CO.

Shifting Food Lifestyle Patterns Among Food Consumers 2020-2022

- Selected Poster Presentation for the 2023 Annual Meeting of the Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) in Washington, D.C.

Why Is the Implementation of The Florida Citrus Fruit Crop Actual Production History Crop Insurance Policy Flawed for The Case of Florida Citrus?

- Selected Paper Presentation for the 2022 Annual Meeting of the Food Distribution Research Society (FDRS) in Pensacola, Florida.
- Selected Poster Presentation for the 2022 Annual Meeting of the Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) in Anaheim, California.

Analysis of the Florida Citrus Fruit Crop Actual Production History Crop Insurance Policy

- Selected Presentation for the Three Minutes Thesis Competition at the 2022 Annual Meeting of the Southern Agricultural Economics Association (SAEA) in New Orleans, Louisiana.

Teaching Experience

Graduate Teaching Assistant | University of Florida, Gainesville, Florida | Fall 2025

AEB2372 - “The Economics of Eating.”

Instructor: Dr. Misti Sharp.

- Conducted quiz and assignment grading and proctored class presentations for a class of 75+ undergraduate students.
- Hold office hours to support student learning.

- Deliver guest lectures on “*Behavioral Economics*” and “*Food-Related Behavioral Changes During Crisis*”

Math Camp Instructor| Food and Resource Economics Department, University of Florida, Gainesville, Florida | Summer 2025

- Co-designed and delivered intensive quantitative preparation workshops for incoming Ph.D. students in Food and Resource Economics.
- Taught modules in linear algebra, matrix theory, probability theory I & II, and applied quantitative methods for graduate-level economics coursework.
- Led the R laboratory component covering data handling, data visualization, and introductory econometric analysis in R.
- Facilitated problem-solving sessions and supported students in developing analytical and computational skills for first-year doctoral coursework.

Graduate Teaching Assistant | University of Florida, Gainesville, Florida | Fall 2023 – Fall 2024
IDS2935 - “The Economics of Eating.”

Instructor: Dr. Lijun Chen.

- Conducted quiz and assignment grading and proctored class presentations for a class of over 40 undergraduate students.
- Held office hours to support student learning.

Graduate Teaching Assistant | University of Florida, Gainesville, Florida | Spring 2023
IDS2935 - “How do we end poverty.”

Instructor: Dr. Xumin Zhang.

- Conducted quiz grading proctored in-class examinations for a class of 75 undergraduate students.
- Organized and coordinated food bank volunteering activities for the students.
- Delivered guest lectures on “*Educational Development In Nigeria: An Avenue To Escape Poverty?*”

Teaching Assistant | University of Florida, Gainesville, Florida | Summer 2022

- Researched content and created animated video scripts for the AEB 6183 (Agribusiness Risk Management) course.
- Updated course contents for the subsequent semester into the Canvas platform.

Professional Development and Academic Training

International Workshop on Survey Design and Experimental Methods in Applied and Agricultural Economics | Michigan State University | Summer 2026

- Completed weeklong intensive training in survey design, valuation and experimental auctions, discrete choice experiments, field experiments, behavioral and policy interventions, and applied econometric methods.

Preparing Future Faculty (PFF) Program| University of Florida | Spring 2026

- Selected participant in university-wide faculty preparation program focused on teaching, academic career development, mentorship, and higher education leadership.

Awards, Honors, and Grants

2026

- Harold B. Clark Award, Food and Resource Economics Department, University of Florida (\$2,500).

- AAEA Trust Travel Grant Award for the International Workshop on Survey Design and Experimental Methods in Applied and Agricultural Economics (\$500)

2025

- 1st AAEA Graduate Student and Agribusiness Economics and Management Sections Case Study Competition (\$500)
- 3rd Place, IFAMA Venture Building Challenge (\$500)
- A.S. Herlong Scholarship, College of Agricultural and Life Sciences, University of Florida (\$2,000)
- 2nd Place, Florida Agricultural Policy Outlook Graduate Student Poster Competition (\$300)

2024

- Phillip L. Herndon Endowment in Economics, Food and Resource Economics Department, University of Florida (\$2,500).
- 2nd Place, IFAMA Venture Building Challenge (\$1,000)

2023

- PepsiCo Inspire Ag. Scholarship (\$2,500)
- 3rd Place, University of Florida Three-Minutes Thesis competition (\$400)
- University of Florida Board of Education Summer Fellowship (\$2,000)
- Best Academic Poster Award from the Food and Resource Economics Department. “Shifting Food Lifestyle Patterns Among Food Consumers, 2020-2022”.
- Ofelia Anzola Memorial Scholarship, College of Agricultural and Life Sciences, University of Florida (\$1,500).
- Phillip L. Herndon Endowment in Economics, Food and Resource Economics Department, University of Florida (\$2,500).

2022

- Certificate of outstanding achievement, international student achievement awards, University of Florida.
- Ofelia Anzola Memorial Scholarship, College of Agriculture and Life Sciences, University of Florida (\$1,500).
- Phillip L. Herndon Endowment in Economics, Food and Resource Economics Department, University of Florida (\$2,500).
- AAEA Travel Grant to attend the 2022 AAEA annual meeting in Anaheim, California (\$500).
- Outstanding Graduate Student Poster award for the specialty crop economics section of the AAEA.
- 3rd Place, SAEA 3-minute thesis competition (\$100).
- College of Agricultural and Life Sciences travel grant to attend the 2022 SAEA annual meeting in Louisiana, New Orleans (\$250).

2021

- Graduate Student Organization (GSO) travel grant award to attend the 2022 SAEA annual meeting in Louisiana New Orleans (\$350).

Professional Affiliations

- | | |
|--|----------------|
| • Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA) | Student Member |
| • Southern Agricultural Economics Association (SAEA) | Student Member |
| • International Food and Agribusiness Management Association (IFAMA) | Student Member |
| • Alpha Epsilon Lambda | Member |

Professional and Leadership Service

- Vice President, University of Florida Graduate Student Council. 2026/2027.
- Director, Graduate Student Affairs, University of Florida Student Government Cabinet. 2025/2026.
- Social Chair, University of Florida Graduate Student Council. 2025/2026.
- President, Applied Economics Graduate Student Organization. 2024/2025.
- Graduate Student Representative, CALS Dean Search Committee, 2024.
- Vice president (Socials), Applied Economics Graduate Student Organization. 2023/2024.
- Treasurer, Minorities in Agriculture, Natural Resources and Related Sciences (MANRRS). University of Florida Chapter. 2022/2023; 2023/2024.
- Secretary, Applied Economics Graduate Student Organization. 2022/2023.
- Master's Student Representative, Food and Resource Economics Graduate Student Organization. 2021/2022.
- Volunteer, Grace Market Place Homeless Shelter, Gainesville, Florida. February 2022; 2023; 2024.
- Volunteer, Bread of the Mighty Food Bank, Gainesville, Florida. February – April 2023.
- Volunteer, North Florida Sewing Center, Gainesville, Florida. August 2023.

Skills

- **Programming & Data Analysis:** Python, R, Stata, SQL, SmartPLS 4, Ngene, Microsoft Excel.
- **Statistical Modeling:** Latent Class Analysis, Monte Carlo Simulations, Regression Analysis, Structural Equations Modelling, Difference in Difference, Valuation Methods, Time Series Forecasting.
- **Machine Learning:** Tree-Based Methods, Convolutional Neural Networks, K-Means Clustering, Deep Learning, Unsupervised Learning.
- **Documentation & Presentation:** R Markdown, Latex, PowerPoint, Academic and Professional Presentations.